

THE FIVE-MINUTE SECOND OPINION

There is a decision that has been sitting on you for a few weeks now. Second truck or second dispatcher. Drop the account that is twenty percent of revenue and most of your headaches. Hire the guy or keep doing it yourself at ten at night.

This is **one prompt**. Paste it into whatever AI you already have open, hand it your decision, and three advisors argue about it in front of you. Then one of them calls it.

01 • THE PROMPT

TAKE IT WITH YOU

You are three advisors. I am going to give you a decision I have been sitting on. Argue it out in front of me, then call it.

One short paragraph from each of the three. Use my words, not consultant words.

- 1. THE ONE WHO WANTS IT TO WORK.** Make the honest best case. Not a pep talk. What actually goes right, and what has to be true for that to happen.
- 2. THE ONE WHO HAS SEEN IT FAIL.** Name the specific way this goes wrong for a business my size. "There are risks" is not an answer. Give me the actual failure, and the first sign I would see it coming.
- 3. THE ONE WHO ASKS WHAT I AM AVOIDING.** Assume there is a reason this has been sitting on me for weeks. Say what you think that reason is, out loud, even if it is uncomfortable to read.

Then step out of all three and close it.

- **VERDICT:** do it, change it, or drop it. One sentence, and why.
- The assumption this whole thing rests on. If that one is wrong, the verdict flips.
- The first move, this week.
- The one question only I can answer.

Be direct. No flattery. Do not agree with me just because I asked.

My decision is: [one sentence, in your own words]

What you should know about my business first: [what you do, how many people, anything that changes the answer]

02 • HOW TO RUN IT

TWO MINUTES, TOPS

- 1** Open ChatGPT, Claude, Gemini, whichever one is already on your phone. Start a new chat and paste this in.
- 2** Fill in the two lines at the bottom, send it, and read the whole answer back. Including the part you were hoping it would skip.

03 • WHAT TO RUN IT ON

GIVE IT A REAL ONE

It is wasted on a decision you have already made. Give it the one that keeps sliding to next week.

YOU WOULD TYPE IN

Second truck or second dispatcher. Six guys, we turn down work most Fridays, and I am still the one answering the phone at seven in the morning.

OR YOU WOULD TYPE IN

Whether to drop the account that is twenty percent of revenue and about eighty percent of the headaches. They pay at sixty days, and my best installer has started asking to be taken off that job.

Yours will be more specific than either of those, and it should be. The more you put in the first time, the less generic what comes back.

04 • WHO SENT YOU THIS

BOUBACAR BARRY

I run Catalyst Works. I sit with owner operators around the Salt Lake valley, most of them under twenty people, and we work out where the week is getting stuck and what is worth pointing at it first.

I run a longer version of this on my own calls. The third voice is in there because I am the one who needed it.

If you run this and the verdict lands somewhere you did not expect, that is usually worth half an hour out loud. I keep some open.

BOOK THIRTY MINUTES →

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